



AI PERSONALISATION & MEMORY

- **AI Memory System (Emotional Profiling)**
Each session quietly tracks the user's emotional tone — grateful, struggling, seeking, growing. Stored per session and used to shape the voice and depth of every AI response.
- **Walk Today !' Memory Integration**
When all 5 evening pillars are answered, the emotional data (which pillars were hard, which were strong) is written to the memory profile automatically. Path AI knows the context of the user's day without them having to repeat it.
- **Relationship Age Tracking**
The app tracks how many days the user has been with Shepherd's Path. This affects tone, milestone cards, suggested journeys, and how Path AI addresses the user over time.
- **Contextual Pre-Fill Pipeline**
When a user answers a check-in, completes Walk Today, or taps a mood chip, a specific contextual message is constructed and stored in local memory. Path AI opens pre-loaded with that context — the user just taps send.
- **Daily Checkin Persistence**
Today's emotion selection is stored locally. Downstream cards (gratitude prompt, Walk Today) read this to personalise their copy — e.g. 'Breathe a moment' for Anxious vs. 'Hold onto that' for Hopeful.
- **Session-Based Identity (No Login Required)**
All personalisation — streak, rhythm, checkin state, journal, memory — is maintained via a session ID stored locally. No account creation required for a deeply personalised experience.

TIME-AWARE CONTENT LOGIC

- **Late-Night Mode (11 PM – 5 AM)**
The entire home screen content set shifts after 11 PM. Energetic cards are hidden. The Late-Night Presence Banner surfaces. Verse anchor, mood chips, and TheReturnCard are all suppressed.
- **"Your Walk Today" Evening Gate (5 PM+)**
The Walk Today card is invisible until 5 PM — it only surfaces at the time of day it's meant for, preventing 'END OF DAY' from appearing at 9 AM.
- **TheReturnCard Phase Engine**
A phase calculation runs on every home screen load — assigning the user to one of four states (morning, midday, evening, close). Each phase has different copy, colour, and CTA directing the user to the right activity for that time of day.
- **Streak Whisper Gating**
The day streak indicator only shows if the user has 2+ days AND it isn't late-night. Prevents displaying an achievement reminder at 2 AM.
- **Verse Anchor Late-Night Suppression**
The full-width daily verse card is hidden during late-night hours, reducing visual load and matching the quieter tone of that window.

ENGAGEMENT & RETENTION LOGIC

- **Gratitude Once-Per-Week Gate**
The gratitude prompt tracks whether the user has submitted one this calendar week. Once submitted, it stays hidden until the following week — it never nags.
- **Weekly Reflection Once-Per-Week Gate**
The rotating reflection question marks itself as seen once engaged or dismissed. A fresh question appears the following week.

- **Sunday Summary Gate**

The Sunday summary card checks for Sunday AND whether it has been dismissed this week. It will not re-appear during the same Sunday after dismissal.

- **Walk Milestone Detection (30/60/100 days)**

The system checks relationship age on every home screen load and surfaces a milestone card only at the exact thresholds — never again after dismissal.

- **Returning User Detection**

The app calculates days since last visit. If it exceeds a threshold, the Returning User card appears with warm, non-shaming copy. It checks for today-dismissal so it only shows once per day.

- **Notification Nudge (One-Time)**

A notification permission prompt is shown exactly once after the user has demonstrated engagement. It never reappears after dismissal.

- **Pro Nudge Trigger Logic**

The Pro upgrade card surfaces only when: the user has a qualifying streak, has set up a rhythm, and has not dismissed it before. It combines three signals to show at the highest-intent moment.

- **First Steps Card (Days 1–7 Only)**

An onboarding card that surfaces exclusively in the first 7 days of the user's relationship with the app, then permanently retires.

NOTIFICATIONS & SCHEDULED DELIVERY

- **Push Notification Scheduler**

Timed pushes scheduled for: morning arrival (11 AM), midday check-in (4 PM), evening reflection (8 PM), and streak reminder (9 PM). Runs server-side on a daily cycle.

- **SMS Daily Devotional Scheduler**

A separate scheduled job delivers a daily devotional via SMS to opted-in users at 9 AM. Powered by Twilio. Runs only in production.

- **Email System (Resend Integration)**

Transactional and devotional emails routed through Resend. Scheduler gated to production environment to prevent dev-mode sends.

CONTENT & ART GENERATION

- **Daily Art Generation Pipeline**

Each day a unique landscape art piece is generated and stored server-side, paired with a scripture reference and reflection. Served from a static daily cache to avoid regeneration on every load.

- **AI Verse Art (Share Feature)**

A separate, visually richer art piece is generated per verse specifically for share cards — optimised for the aspect ratios of social platforms.

- **Anchor Verse Daily Rotation**

The home screen's Today's Verse card rotates through a pool of 30 carefully selected verses using a date-seeded index — ensuring a different verse each day without repetition within a month.

- **Faith Framework Engine**

When a user sets up a rhythm (Focus + pace preference), the system maps their focus to specific verse pools, prayer prompt categories, and recommended Bible journey IDs — all surfaced passively without user-visible configuration.

PAYMENTS & SUBSCRIPTIONS

- **Stripe Web Subscription**

Pro subscriptions on web are processed via Stripe. Webhook handler verifies payment events and updates subscription state in the database.

- **iOS App Store Billing**

In-app purchases on iOS use Apple's StoreKit. The server validates receipts and tracks Pro status

independently of web subscriptions.

- **Google Play Billing**

Android in-app purchases via Google Play Billing API. Pro status is verified server-side via Google's purchase verification endpoint.

- **Referral Pro System**

A referral code system grants temporary Pro access. The server checks referral status on each session and returns expiry date for UI display.

- **AI Usage Metering**

Free-tier AI usage is tracked per session per day. The server-side counter enforces limits and returns the remaining count to the frontend for display.

INFRASTRUCTURE & RELIABILITY

- **Health Check Endpoint**

A `/api/health` endpoint returns server status and is polled by the workflow monitor. Ensures the server is live before any user-facing request completes.

- **Error Boundary (Global)**

A custom React error boundary wraps the entire app. On crash, it shows the 'Something interrupted the experience' screen with a soft reload option instead of a blank white screen.

- **Graceful OpenAI Failure Handling**

If the OpenAI API is slow or unavailable, responses degrade gracefully — the UI shows a soft message rather than crashing or hanging silently.

- **iOS / Android Detection**

The server and client both detect the user's platform. Store links, billing flows, and certain UI elements adapt automatically — iOS users never see the Google Play button and vice versa.

- **Demo / Church Mode**

A demo configuration flag enables white-label behaviour — a church name can be embedded in the hero and specific content can be scoped to that community.

- **Daily Art Static Cache**

Generated artwork is stored as dated static files and served directly — no AI generation cost or latency on repeat loads of the same day's content.

- **Streak & Visit Date Tracking**

Visit dates are stored server-side per session. Streak calculation is derived from consecutive visit dates, not a simple counter — accurate even if the user visits multiple times in a day.

